

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Extreme cold

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Get into a warm, dry place, replace wet clothing and add dry layers. Confusion, extreme drowsiness or loss of coordination can indicate hypothermia; call emergency services. Use safe heat and never bring grills or generators indoors.

Do now.

☐**Get sheltered**

01

Limit outdoor exposure and protect hands, feet, head and face.

☐**Change wet clothing**

02

Use dry layers and blankets; warm the body gently.

☐**Find safe heat**

03

Use approved heaters as directed, keep them away from combustibles and maintain CO alarms.

☐**Arrange help**

04

If heat fails, contact local warming shelters and help people with limited mobility relocate safely.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use one dry room, layered clothing, blankets and insulation beneath you. Keep fuel-burning outdoor equipment outside. If you cannot keep people warm, identify a reachable warm place before they become confused or weak; do not wait for a warming centre to open.

Watch for.

Do not rub frostbitten skin or apply direct intense heat.

People & practical needs.

Check children, older adults and people with limited movement rather than relying only on their report that they feel fine. Keep dry layers and a reachable warmer location in the plan

Next decision.

Keep medicines, transport and backup plans ready. Watch for numb, pale or waxy skin that may signal frostbite.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Extreme cold · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/extreme-cold/>